# Reading and writing an email

Nombre: _____ Fecha: _____

## Qué vas a aprender

- Recognise the parts of an email (partes de un correo)
- Read an email and find key information
- Write an informal email to a friend with greetings, paragraphs and closings
- Use connectors and check your writing

## Para pensar

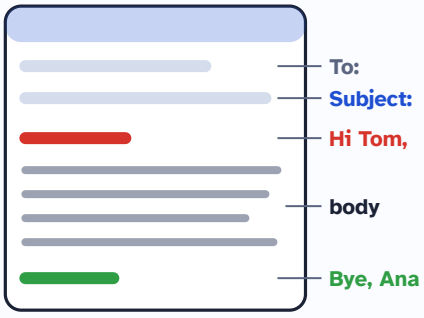
**Si escribes a un amigo de Inglaterra, ¿empezarías con «Dear Sir» o con «Hi Tom»? ¿Y cómo te despedirías?**

## Explicación

### The parts of an email

An email has several parts: the address (**To:**), the subject (asunto: what it is about), the greeting (saludo), the **body** (the message, in paragraphs), the closing (despedida) and your **name**.

**En castellano:** el asunto debe ser corto y claro, por ejemplo «Party on Saturday!» o «Photos from the trip». Así la otra persona sabe de qué trata antes de abrirlo. Después del saludo ponemos una **coma** y empezamos el texto en la línea de abajo.




### Greetings and closings

In an **informal** email (to friends and family) we start with Hi..., Hello..., or Dear..., and we finish with **Love,** (family and close friends), **See you soon, Bye for now, Take care,** or **Best wishes,**.

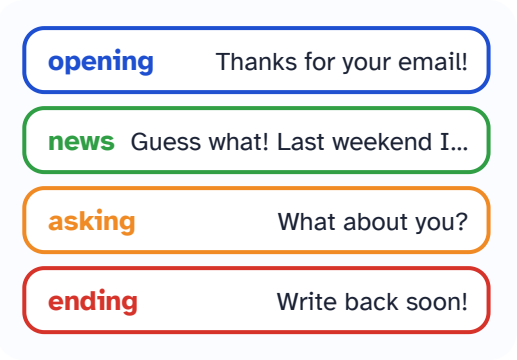
In a **formal** email we start with **Dear Mr Smith,** / **Dear Ms Jones,** / **Dear Sir or Madam,** and finish with **Kind regards,** or **Yours sincerely,**. **En castellano:** es como la diferencia entre «¡Hola, Pablo!» y «Estimado señor:».

| | Informal | Formal |
|---|---|---|
| **Start** | Hi Tom, | Dear Mr Smith, |
| **End** | Love, / Bye! | Kind regards, |

## Useful phrases

**Opening:** «How are you?», «Thanks for your email», «It was great to hear from you», «Sorry I didn't write sooner». **Giving news:** «Guess what!», «I've got some exciting news», «Last weekend I…».

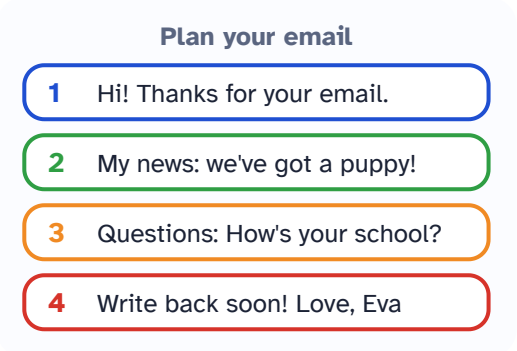
**Asking:** «What about you?», «Can you come?», «Write back soon!». **Ending:** «I hope to see you soon», «Say hello to your family», «That's all for now». **Consejo:** estas frases hechas son como piezas de Lego: con ellas tu correo sonará natural.




## Paragraphs

Organise the body in paragraphs (párrafos), one idea in each. A good plan for a short email: **1)** greeting and why you are writing; **2)** your news or the main information; **3)** questions for your friend; **4)** closing.

Leave a **blank line** between paragraphs. Keep sentences short and clear. **En castellano:** un correo de una sola parrafada es difícil de leer; separar las ideas ayuda a quien lo recibe.




## Connectors

Connectors join ideas: **and** (y) adds information, **but** (pero) shows a contrast, **because** (porque) gives a reason, **so** (así que) gives a result, and **also** (también) adds an idea.

«I love my new school **because** the teachers are very nice». «It was raining, **so** we stayed at home». «The film was long **but** exciting». Order words: **first, then, after that, finally**. **Consejo:** usa al menos tres conectores distintos en cada email.

| Connector | Spanish |
|---|---|
| **and** | y |
| **but** | pero |
| **because** | porque |
| **so** | así que |

## Reading: an email from a friend

Read the email. **Subject: My birthday party!** «Hi Lucas, How are you? Thanks for the photos of your holiday. They're fantastic! Guess what! It's my birthday next Saturday **and** I'm having a party at the climbing centre. It starts at five o'clock **and** finishes at eight. My mum is going to make a big chocolate cake. Can you come? Please tell me **because** I need to book the places. Write back soon! Love, Mia»

Answer: Where is the party? What time does it start? Why does Mia need an answer?

| | |
|---|---|
| **What?** | birthday party |
| **Where?** | at the climbing centre |
| **When?** | Saturday, 5 to 8 o'clock |
| **Why reply?** | to book the places |

## Writing a reply

A **reply** (respuesta) answers all the questions. Lucas writes: «Hi Mia, Thanks for the invitation! I'd love to come to your party. Climbing is my favourite sport. My dad can take me, **so** I'll be there at five. Do I need special shoes? See you on Saturday! Lucas».

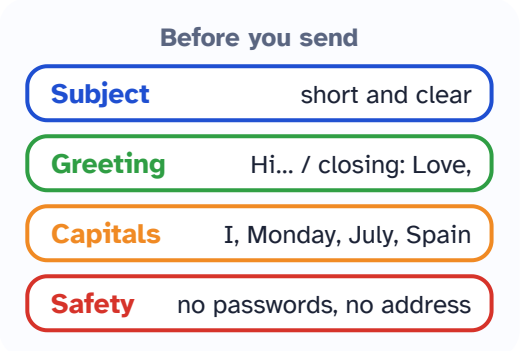
If you can't go, say sorry and give a reason: «I'm really sorry, **but** I can't come **because** I'm visiting my grandparents». **En castellano:** responde siempre a la pregunta principal al principio, y luego añade detalles.




## Check before you send

Before clicking **Send**, use this checklist: Is the **subject** clear? Did I use a **greeting** and a **closing**? Are there **paragraphs**? Did I answer **all the questions**? Did I use **capital letters** for names, days and months (Monday, July) and for **I**? Are the verbs in the right tense?

**Safety online:** only write to people you know, never share passwords or your address with strangers, and ask an adult if a message seems strange. **En castellano:** en internet, la prudencia es lo primero.



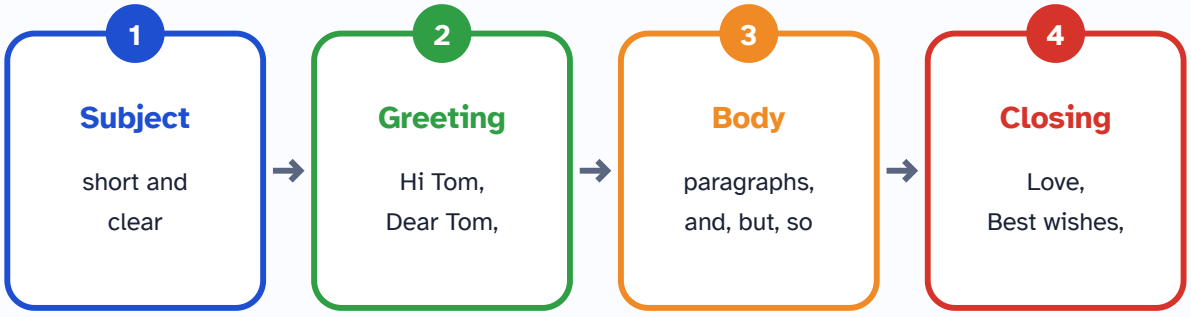

## Let's practise: email exchange

Write an email to a pen friend (amigo por correspondencia) from another country. Tell them about you, your family, your school and your town. Ask three questions. Swap emails with a partner and write a reply.

Use this model: «Hi Sam, My name is Pablo and I'm eleven. I live in Teruel, a small city in Spain. I've got one sister. I love football **and** drawing, **but** I don't like Maths very much! What about you? What sports do you play? Write back soon! Best wishes, Pablo».

| | |
|---|---|
| **Hi Sam,** | greeting |
| **My name is...** | about me |
| **What about you?** | questions |
| **Best wishes,** | closing + name |

## Writing an email



## Ejercicios

1. **Name four parts of an email.**

2. **Write two informal closings.**

3. **Is «Kind regards» formal or informal?**

4. **Complete: «I'm happy ___ it's Friday!»**

5. **Complete: «I like pizza, ___ I don't like olives.»**

6. **Correct the capitals: «on monday i'm going to london.»**

7. **Write an opening sentence to thank a friend for their email.**

8. **Write a sentence to say no to an invitation politely.**

9. **What should you never share in an email to a stranger?**

10. **Write a short email (40 words) to invite a friend to the cinema.**

## Practica

1. **The «subject» of an email is...**
   - **A)** the greeting
   - **B)** what it is about
   - **C)** your name
2. **An informal greeting:**
   - **A)** Dear Sir,
   - **B)** Yours sincerely,
   - **C)** Hi Tom,
3. **An informal closing:**
   - **A)** Love,
   - **B)** Dear,
   - **C)** To:
4. **A formal closing:**
   - **A)** Bye for now,
   - **B)** See ya!
   - **C)** Kind regards,
5. **«because» means...**
   - **A)** pero
   - **B)** porque
   - **C)** así que
6. **«It was late, ___ we went home.»**
   - **A)** so
   - **B)** but
   - **C)** because
7. **Which needs a capital letter?**
   - **A)** school
   - **B)** Tuesday
   - **C)** dog
8. **«Write back soon!» means...**
   - **A)** ¡Escribe más largo!

**B)** ¡Vuelve pronto!

**C)** ¡Contesta pronto!

9. **One idea per...**

**A)** paragraph

**B)** subject

**C)** closing

10. **What should you NOT send to a stranger?**

**A)** a greeting

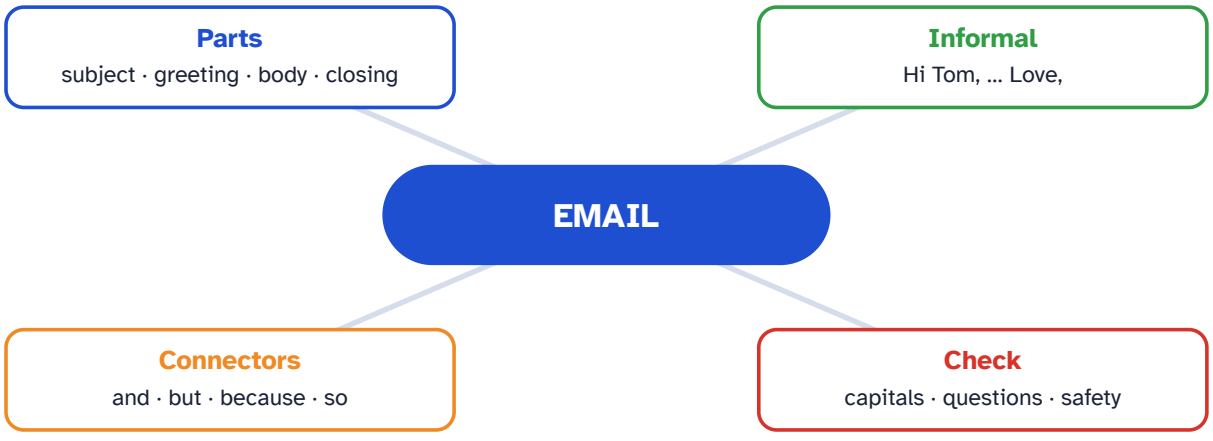
**B)** your password

**C)** a question

## Explícalo con tus palabras

Incluye: Cuáles son las partes de un email; Diferencia entre email formal e informal; Para qué sirven los conectores and, but, because y so; Qué hay que revisar antes de enviar.

## Resumen



## Tarjetas de repaso

Recórtalas: pregunta delante, respuesta detrás.

**Subject**

Asunto: de qué trata el email.

**Hi… / Dear…**

Saludos de un email informal.

**Love, / Best wishes,**

Despedidas informales.

**Kind regards,**

Despedida formal.

**because**

Porque: da una razón.

**so**

Así que: da un resultado.

**Write back soon!**

¡Contesta pronto!

**Paragraph**

Párrafo: una idea en cada uno.

## Soluciones

1. **B)** Asunto.
2. **C)** Para amigos.
3. **A)** Despedida familiar.
4. **C)** Formal.
5. **B)** Da una razón.
6. **A)** Resultado.
7. **B)** Días de la semana.
8. **C)** Pide respuesta.
9. **A)** Párrafo.
10. **B)** Seguridad.

## Soluciones de los ejercicios

1. Subject, greeting, body, closing (y To / name).
2. Love, / Best wishes, / See you soon, / Bye for now,
3. Formal.
4. because.
5. but.
6. On Monday I'm going to London.
7. Thanks for your email! / It was great to hear from you.
8. I'm really sorry, but I can't come because I've got a match.
9. Passwords, your address, phone number or photos.
10. Model answer: Hi Leo, Do you want to come to the cinema on Saturday? There's a new animated film. It starts at six. My mum can pick you up. Write back soon! Bye, Nora